

Recent Malware Incidents Report

Summary, Attack Methods, and Mitigations

LockBit Ransomware (2025)

LockBit is a type of ransomware that locks up files on computers and asks for money to unlock them. In 2025, a new version called **LockBit 5.0** started spreading again.

How it attacked:

- Hackers sent fake emails or used stolen passwords to enter systems.
- Once inside, they installed the ransomware, which locked all important files.
- The hackers then asked the victims to pay a ransom.

How it was stopped:

- Companies disconnected infected computers from the network.
- They used backups to restore their files.
- Security experts and police tracked the hackers' online servers and blocked them.
- Organizations updated their software to fix weak points.

Cl0p (Clop) — Oracle Software Attack

A hacker group called **Cl0p** used a bug in Oracle's business software to steal company data and demand ransom.

How it attacked:

- They found a weakness in Oracle E-Business Suite that let them enter without a password.
- After breaking in, they stole data and emailed company leaders to demand money.

How it was stopped:

- Oracle quickly released an update to fix the bug.
 - Companies installed the update and checked for suspicious activity.
 - Many enabled extra login protection (like two-step verification).
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MuddyWater (Phoenix Malware)

A hacking group called **MuddyWater**, linked to Iran, spread a malware called **Phoenix**. It mainly targeted government offices in the Middle East.

How it attacked:

- Hackers used fake emails from trusted people to send the malware.
- Once someone clicked the link, the malware secretly entered the system.
- It allowed hackers to spy and steal information.

How it was stopped:

- IT teams changed passwords and turned on multi-factor login.
- They removed the malware from infected computers.
- Governments shared warnings and tips to prevent future attacks.

In 2025, LockBit 5.0, ClOp, and MuddyWater malware attacked systems through phishing and software flaws, stealing data and locking files. They were stopped using patches, backups, and stronger security measures.